

F5 Daily Briefing - Tuesday, July 28, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

32

ANNOUNCEMENTS

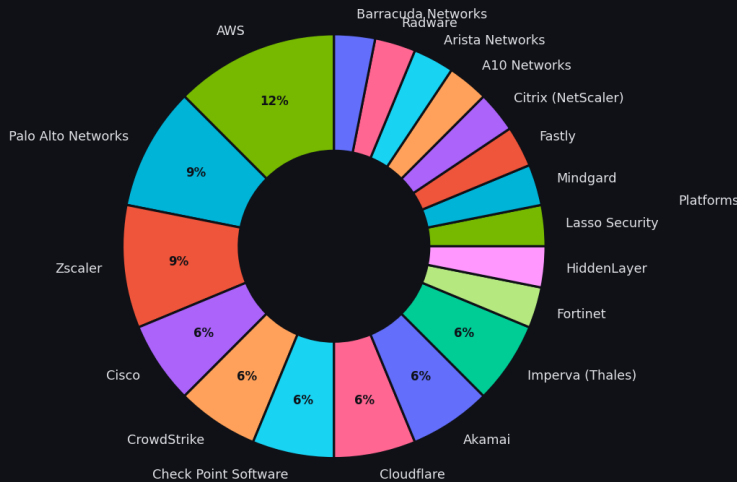
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ACTIVE

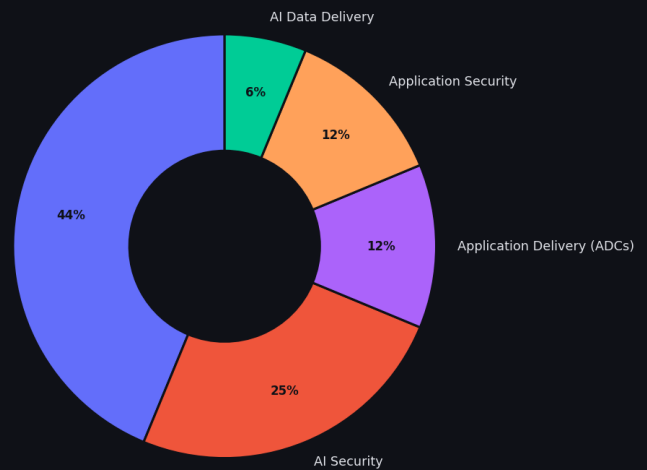
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ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (32)

Product Launch

Palo Alto Networks

Jul 28, 2026

Palo Alto Networks Launches Cortex Cloud 2.2 Unifying Posture, Runtime and AppSec

Palo Alto Networks introduced Cortex Cloud 2.2, a platform update that accelerates critical response across cloud posture, runtime, and application security. The release strengthens software supply chain security and adds unified code-to-cloud visibility with graph-powered context so teams can identify, prioritize, and remediate risk in one workflow. It also introduces agentless malware detection and enhanced runtime protection aimed at complex attack paths created by AI-enabled threats, consolidating multiple cloud security functions into the single Cortex platform.

Source: <https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/cloud-security/cortex-cloud-2-2/>

Product Launch

Palo Alto Networks

Jul 28, 2026

Cortex Cloud Adds Agentless Malware Sandboxing Powered by Advanced WildFire

Palo Alto Networks added agentless malware sandboxing to Cortex Cloud, automatically detaining unknown or evasive files found during agentless registry scans. Suspicious samples pass through local YARA filtering and are then routed to Advanced WildFire for inline machine learning and dynamic sandbox analysis in isolation, with verdicts returned directly into CNAPP cloud-native protection findings. The capability closes a detection gap for evasive cloud threats without requiring agents deployed on workloads.

Source: <https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/cloud-security/agentless-malware-sandboxing/>

Award

Palo Alto Networks

Jul 28, 2026

Palo Alto Networks Achieves Global CBPR and PRP Privacy Certifications

Palo Alto Networks announced it earned Global Cross-Border Privacy Rules (CBPR) Certification and Global Privacy Recognition for Processors (PRP) Certification. The third-party audited credentials, built on the APEC Privacy Framework and expanded by the Global CBPR Forum, validate that the company's data privacy and processing practices meet rigorous international standards. The milestone supports customers with cross-border data transfer requirements and reinforces the vendor's compliance posture across global markets.

Source: <https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/2026/07/palo-alto-networks-achieves-global-cbpr-and-prp-certifications/>

Product Launch **Fortinet** Jul 28, 2026

Fortinet Expands FortiGate G Series with 1200G and FortiSASE Outpost

Fortinet expanded its FortiGate G Series with the FortiGate 1200G and a new FortiSASE Outpost, advancing firewall and SASE convergence. The 1200G delivers up to 397 Gbps firewall throughput, 40 Gbps threat protection, and 102 Gbps IPsec VPN with 10G/25G/100G connectivity via FortiASIC. FortiSASE Outpost acts as an on-site SASE point of presence, processing sovereignty-sensitive or latency-critical traffic locally while cloud-delivered security handles the rest. FortiGate 1200G is expected in Q3 2026.

Source: <https://www.fortinet.com/corporate/about-us/newsroom/press-releases/2026/fortinet-expands-fortigate-g-series-with-1200g-and-fortisase-outpost-to-advance-firewall-sase-convergence>

Product Launch **Cisco** Jul 28, 2026

Cisco Readies Cloud Control Agentic Platform and Deep Networking AI Models

Cisco detailed Cloud Control, an agent-based platform spanning its product portfolio to query infrastructure, diagnose issues, and assess blast radius before actions, reducing console sprawl. Cisco also confirmed purpose-built AI models that understand routing and switching configurations, which will be published on Hugging Face alongside its Antares security models and can run on-premises on Cisco UCS. Cloud Control reaches US customers by end of August with token-based consumption pricing bundled into existing subscriptions, followed by Europe and Asia-Pacific.

Source: <https://www.theregister.com/networks/2026/07/28/cisco-close-to-releasing-more-ai-models-this-time-for-deep-networking-ops/5279350>

Product Launch **Cisco** Jul 28, 2026

Cisco Introduces Antares Open-Weight AI Models for Vulnerability Localization

Cisco launched Antares, a family of compact open-weight small language models built to localize software vulnerabilities inside an organization's own codebase. Two releases, Antares-350M and Antares-1B, run entirely on-premises so source code never leaves the environment, preserving data sovereignty for regulated industries and public sector teams. Cisco says the models investigate vulnerability descriptions and search code in a human-like way, outperforming far larger frontier models on localization at a fraction of the cost.

Source: <https://blogs.cisco.com/ai/introducing-antares-the-most-efficient-open-weight-ai-models-for-vulnerability-localization>

Research **CrowdStrike** Jul 28, 2026

Loop Capital Names CrowdStrike the Cybersecurity Winner of the Agentic AI Era

Loop Capital argued CrowdStrike is best positioned to win as autonomous AI agents reshape enterprise attack surfaces, setting a bullish \$230 price target. The thesis points to CrowdStrike's platform breadth in endpoint protection and threat intelligence, an expected inflection in enterprise adoption of agentic AI defenses, and catalysts including large-scale deployments and cloud/AI platform partnerships. The note frames platform consolidation and AI-driven earnings leverage as the primary drivers of CrowdStrike's trajectory.

Source: <https://www.cnbc.com/2026/07/28/crowdstrike-will-be-the-cybersecurity-winner-in-the-ai-agentic-era-loop-capital-says.html>

Partnership **CrowdStrike** Jul 28, 2026

CrowdStrike Joins NVIDIA and Microsoft to Launch Open Secure AI Alliance

CrowdStrike joined NVIDIA, Microsoft, and more than 30 partners to launch the Open Secure AI Alliance, a coalition building shared open-source tooling for AI safety, security, and resilience. The group targets the full agent stack, covering identity, permissions, harnesses, guardrails, logging, and evaluation rather than model weights alone, with contributions such as NVIDIA's NOAA framework, HPE SPIFFE/SPIRE identity, and Hugging Face Safetensors. Membership gives CrowdStrike earlier visibility into emerging AI attack patterns and shared red-teaming frameworks.

Source: <https://cyberpress.org/nvidia-microsoft-crowdstrike-open-secure-ai-alliance/>

Partnership Zscaler Jul 28, 2026

Zscaler and Schwarz Digits Partner on Sovereign Zero Trust SASE Platform for Europe

Zscaler and Schwarz Digits announced a strategic partnership to deliver a sovereign Zero Trust SASE platform for Europe, running the Zscaler Zero Trust Exchange on Schwarz Digits' STACKIT sovereign cloud in German data centers. STACKIT handles deployment, management, operation, and support, keeping customer data inside the EU. The offering targets public administration, defense, financial services, and healthcare organizations needing hybrid-work security, AI threat protection, third-party access controls, and compliance with European data residency requirements.

Source: <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/07/28/3334014/0/en/Zscaler-and-Schwarz-Digits-Partner-to-Deliver-Sovereign-Cloud-Security-Platform-for-Europe.html>

Product Launch Zscaler Jul 28, 2026

Zscaler Expands Risk360 Availability to Most Customers Over 500 Users

Zscaler made Risk360 available to the majority of customers with more than 500 users by bundling it into most ZIA and platform SKUs. The expansion uses Zscaler-native telemetry, so customers get foundational cyber risk insights with no additional data collection or integrations. Risk360 correlates signals across users, devices, applications, policy configuration, and Zscaler's External Attack Surface Management engine, helping teams prioritize remediation, improve security posture, and communicate security value to executives and boards.

Source: <https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/company-news/expanded-risk360-availability-brings-foundational-risk-insights-more-zscaler>

Other Zscaler Jul 28, 2026

Zscaler to Showcase Zero Trust AI Security Platform for Agentic AI at Black Hat 2026

Zscaler announced it will showcase its Zero Trust-based AI Security Platform at Black Hat 2026, booth #2557, August 4-6. Planned live demonstrations cover extending Zero Trust to AI agents and the actions they take, enterprise-wide visibility into AI usage, governance of agent behavior, and threat hunting at machine speed. The positioning emphasizes securing AI interactions and agentic workflows across users, applications, and endpoints as enterprises scale autonomous AI deployments.

Source: <https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/company-news/secure-agentic-ai-machine-speed-meet-zscaler-black-hat-2026>

Product Launch Check Point Software Jul 28, 2026

Check Point Unveils AI-Powered Seventh-Generation Quantum Smart-1 Management Appliances

Check Point introduced its seventh-generation Quantum Smart-1 management appliances, adding AI-assisted analytics, event prioritization, and automation to unify security operations across hybrid on-premises, cloud, and remote environments. The line delivers up to 2x more managed gateways, roughly 70% faster log processing, up to 70TB of local log retention, and five hardware configurations including high-performance Ultra models. The appliances are fully integrated with the Check Point Infinity Platform and interoperate with more than 250 third-party solutions.

Source: <https://undercodenews.com/check-point-unveils-ai-powered-quantum-smart-1-appliances-to-redefine-enterprise-cybersecurity-management-video/>

Product Launch

Check Point Software

Jul 28, 2026

Check Point Positions AI Agent Security for the Agentic Enterprise, Publishes Playbook

Check Point detailed its AI Agent Security offering, which discovers AI agents across cloud and low-code platforms, assesses risk across tools, skills, MCP servers, and connected components, and evaluates prompts, model responses, external content, and tool calls in context. Governance policies are enforced before sensitive data is exposed or unsafe actions execute. Check Point also promoted an AI Agent Security Enterprise Playbook guiding customers from agent inventory and risk assessment through runtime protection, competing directly with F5's AI Guardrails positioning.

Source: <https://blog.checkpoint.com/ai-security/ai-agent-security-just-had-its-catalyst-moment/>

Research

Cloudflare

Jul 28, 2026

Cloudflare Radar Q2 2026 Internet Disruption Summary

Cloudflare published its Q2 2026 review of major Internet disruption events using Radar data. Highlights include a prolonged outage north of Guam tied to Super Typhoon Sinlaku, repeated government-mandated exam-period shutdowns in Sudan, and an 88-day regional blackout in Iran following drone-related infrastructure damage, plus DNSSEC misconfigurations, cable cuts, earthquakes, and power failures. The report underscores Internet fragility and interdependence, positioning Cloudflare Radar as the authoritative public data source for global connectivity visibility.

Source: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/q2-2026-internet-disruption-summary/>

Product Launch

Cloudflare

Jul 28, 2026

Cloudflare Adds Post-Quantum Authentication for Connections to Customer Origins

Cloudflare announced support for post-quantum authentication on Cloudflare-to-origin connections, extending quantum-resistant protection beyond key exchange to certificate-based authentication. Combined with X25519MLKEM768 key agreement, the update gives customers end-to-end post-quantum security on the reverse-proxy path to their origin servers. The move advances Cloudflare's roadmap of full post-quantum coverage across its entire product suite by 2029, and pressures other proxy and ADC vendors to publish comparable PQC timelines.

Source: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/post-quantum-authentication-to-origins/>

Partnership

AWS

Jul 28, 2026

Recursive Signs \$410 Million Multi-Year Collaboration with AWS to Scale Self-Improving AI

AI research startup Recursive committed to a multi-year, \$410 million collaboration with AWS to run its automated, self-improving AI research system on AWS infrastructure. AWS provides elastic, purpose-built compute enabling massively parallel research loops that compress months of sequential experimentation into days. Recursive's system reportedly beat a two-year human leaderboard and outperformed a live human-AI collaboration across the NanoChat, NanoGPT Speedrun, and SOL-ExecBench benchmarks. The companies will co-develop infrastructure tailored to large-scale automated AI research.

Source: <https://press.aboutamazon.com/aws/2026/7/recursive-signs-410-million-multi-year-collaboration-with-aws-to-scale-self-improving-ai>

Product Launch

AWS

Jul 28, 2026

Second-Generation AWS Outposts Racks Now Supported in Asia Pacific (Mumbai) Region

AWS extended support for second-generation Outposts racks to the Asia Pacific (Mumbai) Region, letting customers order racks anchored to Mumbai for low-latency, on-premises workloads while meeting Indian data residency requirements. Outposts run AWS services and APIs locally and connect back to the home Region for management, giving enterprises a consistent hybrid operating model. The expansion strengthens AWS's hybrid platform reach in a fast-growing market where F5 and other on-premises delivery vendors compete.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/07/aws-outposts-asia-pacific-mumbai/>

Product Launch AWS Jul 28, 2026

AWS AgentCore Gateway Adds Support for the MCP 2026-07-28 Specification

AWS detailed how Amazon Bedrock AgentCore Gateway supports the newly released Model Context Protocol 2026-07-28 specification, letting customers front tools, APIs, and data sources for AI agents through a managed MCP-compliant gateway. The update covers protocol-level changes and how the gateway handles discovery, invocation, and authorization for agent tool calls at scale. As an AI gateway control point for agent traffic, it competes directly with AI gateway and MCP proxy offerings from Cloudflare, Operant AI, and F5.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/machine-learning/how-agentcore-gateway-supports-the-mcp-2026-07-28-spec/>

Product Launch AWS Jul 28, 2026

AWS Adds Native Vector Search to Amazon DynamoDB for AI Applications

AWS updated Amazon DynamoDB with native vector search, allowing developers to store embeddings and run similarity queries directly in DynamoDB rather than bolting on a separate vector database. The change simplifies retrieval-augmented generation and agentic application architectures by keeping operational data and vectors in one managed, low-latency store. Analysts framed the move as AWS pulling more of the AI data-serving stack into its core managed services, squeezing standalone vector database vendors.

Source: <https://www.infoworld.com/article/4202171/aws-updates-dynamodb-with-native-vector-search-to-ease-ai-application-development.html>

Product Launch HiddenLayer Jul 28, 2026

HiddenLayer Ships AI Sec Console 26.7.3 with Asset Inventory API v2.0

HiddenLayer released version 26.7.3 of its AI Sec Console, the management plane for its Security for AI platform spanning AI supply chain security, model scanning, and AI runtime security. The headline change promotes the Asset Inventory API to v2.0 and deprecates v1.0 endpoints, which remain functional pending a future removal announcement, pushing customers toward migration. The release also bundles fixes across discovery, detection, and policy-compliance workflows, signaling continued investment in API-first AI asset visibility.

Source: <https://docs.hiddenlayer.ai/docs/products/console/releasenotes>

Product Launch Lasso Security Jul 28, 2026

Lasso Security Launches Intent Deputy, a Behavioral AI Security Framework

Lasso Security launched Intent Deputy, positioned as the first behavioral intent framework for securing AI agents and the runtime intelligence engine of its AI Security Platform. Rather than inspecting prompt content or data patterns, Intent Deputy builds behavioral baselines for every user, agent, and application, then evaluates goal consistency, scope adherence, and authority alignment to catch deviations from misconfiguration, drift, or malicious intent. Lasso claims sub-50-millisecond blocking, 99.83% detection accuracy, and explainable audit trails for compliance.

Source: <https://www.artiverse.ca/lasso-security-introduces-intent-deputy/>

Research Mindgard Jul 28, 2026

Mindgard Publishes Black-Box Guardrail Reconnaissance Research with Lancaster University

Mindgard announced new research, "Behind the Refusal: Determining Guardrail Activation via Behavioral Monitoring," conducted with Lancaster University. The black-box technique needs only 40 prompts and no knowledge of the target system, using HTTP, lexical, and timing signals to detect whether a guardrail is present. Mindgard reports 100% accuracy identifying guardrail presence across 160+ deployments, the ability to infer which content categories are monitored, and a 98% average F1-score distinguishing guardrail blocks from ordinary LLM refusals.

Source: https://www.linkedin.com/posts/mindgard_behind-the-refusal-how-black-box-guardrail-activity-7480285756448534528-vxot

Partnership Akamai Jul 28, 2026

Akamai Publishes Partner Blueprint for AI-Era Defense with Guardicore Segmentation

Akamai published a partner-facing architectural blueprint for containing AI-era risk using an "assume breach" posture built on Akamai Guardicore Segmentation, ZTNA/MFA, and virtual patching at the edge. The three-phase rollout starts in monitor mode to map application traffic, adds identity-aware access controls, then shifts to enforcement with continuous AI-driven policy generation, protecting model repositories and MCP servers from credential theft and exfiltration. Akamai also outlined a Tier 1/Tier 2 Guardicore-certified Service Partner support model.

Source: <https://www.akamai.com/blog/partners/partners-defend-network-ease-ai-anxiety>

Funding Akamai Jul 28, 2026

Akamai Joins Hush Security's \$30M Series A to Close the AI Agent Governance Gap

Hush Security raised a \$30 million Series A led by Battery Ventures and YL Ventures with Akamai Technologies joining as a strategic investor, bringing total funding to \$41 million. Hush secures the non-human workforce of AI agents and non-human identities with just-in-time, revocable access plus centralized governance, logging, and revocation. Akamai executives framed AI agents and identity as the critical new security layer, signaling Akamai's push into agentic AI identity governance adjacent to its edge security portfolio.

Source: <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/hush-security-raises-30m-to-close-the-ai-agent-governance-gap-with-akamai-joining-as-strategic-investor-302836307.html>

Other Fastly Jul 28, 2026

Fastly to Present at Three Upcoming Investor Conferences

Fastly announced that CFO Rich Wong and VP of Investor Relations Vernon Essi, Jr. will present at three investor conferences: the KeyBanc Capital Markets Technology Leadership Forum on August 10, the Citi 2026 Global TMT Conference on September 9, and the Piper Sandler Growth Frontiers Conference on September 15. Webcasts will be posted to Fastly's investor relations site. The release reiterates Fastly's edge cloud platform positioning across compute, delivery, security, and observability ahead of its August 5 Q2 2026 results.

Source: <https://www.financialcontent.com/article/bizwire-2026-7-28-fastly-to-present-at-upcoming-investor-conferences>

Security Advisory Citrix (NetScaler) Jul 28, 2026

Active Reconnaissance Reported Against Citrix NetScaler CVE-2026-3055 Memory Overread Flaw

Security reporting flagged active reconnaissance against Citrix NetScaler ADC and Gateway tied to CVE-2026-3055, a CVSS 9.3 input-validation flaw that causes a memory overread and can expose sensitive data. Threat actors are probing internet-facing NetScaler instances to identify SAML Identity Provider configurations, the prerequisite for exploitation. Affected builds span 14.1, 13.1, and their FIPS/NDcPP variants, and defenders are urged to patch immediately and monitor for targeted scanning.

Other **A10 Networks** Jul 28, 2026

A10 Networks Promotes Black Hat USA Presence as ATEN Shares Slip 2.33%

A10 Networks pushed its Black Hat USA presence, inviting attendees to booth 5548 with a registration discount code ahead of the July 31 late-registration deadline. The security-conference marketing push comes as ATEN shares fell 2.33% to \$33.47, trading below near-term moving averages, and ahead of A10's Q2 2026 results scheduled for August 5. The activity underscores A10's continued positioning of its ADC and WAAP portfolio to security buyers rather than pure networking audiences.

Source: <https://tradersunion.com/news/companies/show/2820990-a10-networks-slides-2-33percent-today/>

Security Advisory **Arista Networks** Jul 28, 2026

Arista Patches Actively Exploited Critical VeloCloud Orchestrator Zero-Day as CISA Sets Clock

Arista shipped emergency fixes for CVE-2026-16812, a maximum-severity (CVSS 10.0) unauthenticated OS command injection flaw in on-premises VeloCloud Orchestrator that is already being exploited in the wild. Attackers can fully compromise the SD-WAN orchestration host and potentially reach connected VeloCloud Edge devices; the management interface is exposed by default with no workaround. CISA added the bug to its Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog on July 28, and Arista advised credential rotation and rebuilding affected instances.

Source: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/07/28/arista-patches-actively-exploited-velocloud-bug-as-cisa-puts-admins-on-the-clock/>

Award **Radware** Jul 28, 2026

Radware Names Spectrum Business U.S. Managed Security Services Partner of the Year

Radware named Spectrum Business its U.S. Managed Security Services Partner of the Year, citing rapid expansion of Spectrum's managed DDoS protection business built on Radware SecureLink and Cloud Always-On DDoS Protection. The joint offer gives enterprise and mid-market customers per-circuit, scalable mitigation bundled with Spectrum's internet services, using Radware's behavioral and AI-based algorithms plus real-time threat intelligence to block attack traffic while preserving legitimate requests. The award underscores Radware's service-provider channel strategy as a growth engine.

Source: <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/07/28/3334060/8980/en/Spectrum-Business-Named-Radware-U-S-Managed-Security-Services-Partner-of-the-Year-for-Expanding-Managed-DDoS-Protection-Services.html>

Research **Barracuda Networks** Jul 28, 2026

Barracuda Research: "The Scam Economy" Details How Online Fraud Industrialized

Barracuda published threat research describing online fraud as a mature industry with recruitment pipelines, playbooks, CRM-style tooling, performance tracking, and AI-driven automation. Ready-made phishing kits and credential-collection infrastructure are sold through marketplaces much like ransomware-as-a-service, with specialized data brokers, call centers, and laundering networks each handling a stage of the attack. Barracuda cites a Consumer Federation of America estimate of roughly \$119 billion in annual U.S. losses and positions BarracudaONE and Managed XDR for detection and response.

Source: <https://blog.barracuda.com/2026/07/28/scam-economy-online-fraud-industry>

Research **Imperva (Thales)** Jul 28, 2026

Imperva Threat Research: Unpatched Fastjson Zero-Day (CVE-2026-16723) Exploited

Imperva detailed active exploitation of an unpatched Fastjson 1.x flaw, CVE-2026-16723, where an @JSONType annotation is treated as a trust signal during type resolution, bypassing AutoType protections for unauthenticated remote code execution in Spring Boot fat-JAR deployments. Imperva telemetry shows attacks across multiple U.S. industries plus incidents in Singapore and Canada, with most exploit traffic from browser impersonators. With no vendor patch available, Imperva recommends SafeMode, Cloud WAF virtual patching, and migration to Fastjson 2.x.

Source: <https://www.securityweek.com/unpatched-fastjson-vulnerability-exploited-in-attacks/>

Research

Imperva (Thales)

Jul 28, 2026

Imperva Publishes 2026 API Security Token & Authentication Risk Report

Imperva released its API Security Token & Authentication Risk Report, benchmarking 1,104 customer environments and 32,725 API endpoints year over year. Findings show 39.8% of endpoints carry more than one authentication risk simultaneously, sensitive data appears inside JWTs in 49.8% of detections, up from 46.0%, and expired tokens still granting access jumped 70% year over year, the sharpest deterioration of five risk categories. Weak signing algorithms declined about 20%, and the report offers prioritized remediation guidance.

Source: <https://www.imperva.com/resources/resource-library/reports/imperva-api-security-token-authentication-risk-report/>